

Handout 2.14: Investor Journal

Name: _____ Period: _____ Investor number: _____ Start date: _____

This journal stays in your FACS folder for the whole Gilded Age Market. You write one entry every class day. Every entry has three parts and one number:

- **What I did** (bought, sold, or held; which company; how many shares)
- **Why I did it** (a dispatch, a risk level, my pie, a feeling you noticed)
- **What happened** (did the price move, did my total move)
- **My total** at the bell, in dollars (the number on your ledger)

Three sentences and the number is a complete entry. More is welcome.

Sentence starters:

English	Spanish
Today I bought ____ because ____.	Hoy compré ____ porque ____.
Today I sold ____ because ____.	Hoy vendí ____ porque ____.
I did not trade today because ____.	Hoy no hice ninguna operación porque ____.
My total is \$____.	Mi total es \$____.
The news said , so .	La noticia decía , así que .
I felt ____ when the prices dropped.	Me sentí ____ cuando bajaron los precios.
Next time I will ____.	La próxima vez voy a ____.

Journal cover: my notes

The risk ladder (Day 1): copy it here, safest at the bottom.

_____ (riskiest) _____

 _____ (safest)

My risk guess for each company (Day 1): write none, low, medium, high, or very high.

Ticker	Company	On the board from	My guess	Was I right? (fill on Day 9)
BANK	The savings bank	Round 0 (1870)		
RAIL	Pennsylvania Railroad	Round 0 (1870)		
OIL	Standard Oil	Round 0 (1870)		

GAS	Manhattan Gas Light, later Consolidated Gas	Round 0 (1870)		
ELEC	Edison Electric Light, later General Electric	Round 2 (1882)		
STEEL	United States Steel	Round 4 (1901)		
AUTO	General Motors	Round 5 (1911)		
RADIO	Radio Corporation of America	Round 5 (1911)		

My first buys (Round 0, 1870): ticker and shares, and how much went in the bank.

Notes box (rules and definitions from the slides):



Entry 1 (Day 1: Lesson 2.14, the market opens and the Panic of 1873)

What I bought and why (the short version today):

My total at the bell: \$ _____

Entry 2 (Day 2: Lesson 2.14, reading the ledger)

Total at the start (after Round 1): \$ _____ Above or below 1,000? By how much?

My trade log check: _____ shares times \$ _____ = \$ _____ cash moved. Matches? yes / no

What I did:

Why:

What happened:

My pie (rough slices, label each with a ticker):

[draw here]

My total at the bell: \$ _____

Entry 3 (Day 3: Lesson 2.15, reading the news)

My prediction before the Round 3 prices went up (which company is most at risk in a panic, and why):

What I did:

Why (name the dispatch):

What happened:



Did my prediction come true? yes / no. The number that shows it:

My total at the bell: \$ _____

Entry 4 (Day 4: Lesson 2.15, fact vs hype)

What I did:

Why:

What happened:

One headline I ignored today and why (which test did it fail?):

My total at the bell: \$ _____

Entry 5 (Day 5: Lesson 2.16, diversification)

My pie before Round 5 (rough slices, label each with a ticker):

[draw here]

What I did (use the word rebalance or hold):

Why:

What happened:

My biggest slice is _____ percent (ticker: _____). I am comfortable / not comfortable with that because:

My total at the bell: \$ _____

Entry 6 (Day 6: Lesson 2.17, the boom of 1928 and the margin line)

How I felt at the start (one word): _____ A stress sign I noticed: _____

Did I borrow on the margin line? yes / no. If yes, how much: \$ _____

What I did:

Why (copy your decision from the grid):

What happened:

How I feel now (one sentence):

My total at the bell: \$ _____

Entry 7 (Day 7: Lesson 2.17, the crash of October 1929)

My corner today: sold some / sold everything / held / bought more

Margin call: I owed \$ _____ and paid it with cash / shares / it took everything.

What I did:

Why:

What happened:

Look back: my Day 6 decision was a plan / a panic. My evidence (a number):

My total at the bell: \$ _____

Entry 8 (Day 8: Lesson 2.18, the bottom of 1932 and return math)

What I did (rebalance, buy low, or hold; if buying low, which company and what I expect):

Why:

What happened:



My percent return so far (from Return Math Part B): _____ percent

The company that hurt me most fell _____ percent from Round 6 to Round 8 (ticker: _____).

My total at the bell: \$ _____

Entry 9 (Day 9: Lesson 2.19, the closing bell and the reveal)

The market is closed at the 1936 prices. My closing total: \$ _____ My rank: _____ of _____
(by investor number)

Why my final number is what it is (one or two sentences):

What I know now that I did not know on Day 1:

Entry 10 (Day 10: Lesson 2.19, the report)

My final percent return was _____ percent.

One sentence to my future self about money:



The replay: 1925 to 1936, knowing what is coming (Lessons 2.20, 2.21, 2.22)

The market reopens for ten minutes a day with a fresh \$1,000. You now know what happens in 1929 and in 1932.

Block 1 (1925, the buys): I did _____ because _____ Total: \$ _____

Block 2 (October 1929, the crash): I did _____ because _____ Total: \$ _____

Block 3 (1932, then the close at 1936): I did _____ because _____ Total: \$ _____

Knowing the crash was coming, did I still buy on margin? yes / no. Did I buy at the bottom? yes / no. Did knowing change how I traded? How:
